

B1

GRAMMAR LESSON · DETERMINERS & QUANTIFIERS

Few vs A few / Little vs A little

a few / few with countable nouns, a little / little with uncountable — positive or negative?

Few/A few ve Little/A little Farkı

QUICK UNDERSTANDING

Few/a few sayılabilir çoğul isimlerle, **little/a little** ise sayılamayan isimlerle kullanılır — ikisi de "az" anlamına gelir. Ama başındaki "**a**" harfinin olup olmaması cümlelerin anlamını tamamen değiştirir: "**a**" VARSA cümle **olumlu** bir tona sahiptir ("az ama var, yeterli"); "**a**" YOKSA cümle **olumsuz** bir tona sahiptir ("neredeyse hiç yok").

The Structure

Formula

(a) few + ÇOĞUL sayılabilir isim | (a) little + SAYILAMAYAN isim
"a" VARSA → OLURLU (var, yeterli) | "a" YOKSA → OLUMSUZ (yok denecek kadar az)

Affirmative / Negative / Question

Yapı	İsim türü	Anlam / Ton	Örnek
a few	sayılabilir (çoğul)	olumlu — "birkaç tane var"	I have a few ideas.
few	sayılabilir (çoğul)	olumsuz — "neredeyse hiç yok"	Few ideas were useful.
a little	sayılamayan	olumlu — "biraz var"	I have a little money.
little	sayılamayan	olumsuz — "yok denecek kadar az"	I have little money.

Word Order

few/a few/little/a little her zaman isimden hemen önce gelir; quite a few, very little, very few de aynı şekilde doğrudan ismin önünde durur.

- We only have **a few** minutes left. — Sadece birkaç dakikamız kaldı.
- He has **very little** patience with children. — Çocuklara karşı çok az sabrı var.

How It Works

When do we use it?

- **a few + çoğul sayılabilir isim — "birkaç tane var" (olumlu, yeterlilik vurgusu):** I have a few questions for you.
- **few + çoğul sayılabilir isim — "çok az, neredeyse hiç yok" (olumsuz vurgu):** Few people showed up to the meeting.
- **a little + sayılamayan isim — "biraz var" (olumlu):** We have a little time before the train leaves.
- **little + sayılamayan isim — "çok az, yok denecek kadar" (olumsuz vurgu):** There is little hope of finding survivors.
- **quite a few — "a few"den daha fazla, aslında "epey/birçok" anlamında:** Quite a few people disagreed with the plan.
- **very little / very few — vurguyu daha da güçlendirir:** We have very little information about this.

When DON'T we use it?

Little'ı SAYILABİLİR isimlerle, few'ü SAYILAMAYAN isimlerle KULLANMA:

✗ I have little friends. → ✓ I have few friends. (friends sayılabilir)

"a" harfini unutma — cümlelerin anlamını tersine çevirir:

✗ Don't worry, we have little time, so let's relax. (anlam çelişkili) → ✓ Don't worry, we have a little time, so let's relax.

Short Answers

Hızlı hatırlatma: Sayılabilir isim → few ailesi. Sayılamayan isim → little ailesi. "a" varsa olumlu (var), "a" yoksa olumsuz (yok denecek kadar az).

Türkçe Mantığı

Zihninde şu sırayla ilerle:

TÜRKÇEDE NE DEMEK İSTİYORUM? → "Birkaç arkadaşım var (iyi ki var)." → İSİM SAYILABİLİR Mİ? → Evet, arkadaş (friend) sayılabilir → few ailesi → TONUM OLUMLU MU (VAR, YETERLİ) YOKSA OLUMSUZ MU (YOK DENECEK KADAR AZ)? → Olumlu → "a" EKLE → CÜMLE → "I have a few friends." (few değil, a few — çünkü olumlu bir vurgu var)

Examples

A FEW / FEW — SAYILABİLİR

- I made a few new friends at the conference. — Konferansta birkaç yeni arkadaş edindim.
- Could you give me a few examples? — Bana birkaç örnek verebilir misin?
- Few students finished the exam on time. — Çok az öğrenci sınavı zamanında bitirdi.
- Few shops in this area stay open after nine. — Bu bölgede saat dokuzdan sonra açık kalan çok az dükkan var.

A LITTLE / LITTLE — SAYILAMAYAN

- We still have a little time before the flight. — Uçuştan önce hâlâ biraz vaktimiz var.
- She speaks a little Japanese, which helped us in Tokyo. — Biraz Japonca konuşuyor, bu bize Tokyo'da yardımcı oldu.
- There is little chance of the team winning now. — Takımın şimdi kazanma şansı neredeyse hiç yok.
- He showed little interest in the project from the start.

KARŞILAŞTIRMALI KULLANIM

- Quite a few people applied for the job this time. — Bu sefer epey kişi işe başvurdu.
- We have very little information about the accident. — Kaza hakkında çok az bilgimiz var.
- Don't worry — we have a little money saved for emergencies. — Merak etme — acil durumlar için biraz para biriktirdik.

Compare & Notice

Compare With

Few / Little (bu konu)	Much / Many
Bir şeyin AZLIĞINI, sayılabilir/sayılamayan ayrımıyla ve olumlu/olumsuz tonla anlatır. We have little time, but a few good options.	Bir şeyin ÇOKLUĞUNU sormak ya da olumsuzlukla belirtmek için kullanılır; miktarın azlığına değil, genel büyüklüğüne odaklanır. How much time do we have? Not much. → Temel Miktar Sözcükleri konusuna git

Karar Şeması (Decision Guide)

little / few(yok denecek kadar az — olumsuz) ↔ a little / a few(biraz/birkaç var — olumlu) ↔ quite a few / a lot(epey, çok)

Common Mistakes

✗ I have little brothers and sisters.	✓ I have few brothers and sisters.
WHY? brothers and sisters sayılabilen isimlerdir; sayılabilen isimlerle little değil few kullanılır.	
✗ We have a few money left for the trip.	✓ We have a little money left for the trip.
WHY? money sayılamayan bir isimdir; sayılamayan isimlerle few değil little kullanılır.	
✗ Don't worry, we have little time before the meeting starts.	✓ Don't worry, we have a little time before the meeting starts.
WHY? "Don't worry" (merak etme) olumlu bir mesaj verdiği için buradaki anlam "biraz vaktimiz VAR, sorun değil" olmalı; "a" eksik olunca cümle anlamca kendisiyle çelişir.	

✗ Few of my friends helped me, so I finished the project easily.

✓ **A few of my friends helped me, so I finished the project easily.**

WHY? "kolayca bitirdim" olumlu bir sonuç anlattığı için yardımın YETERLİ olduğunu vurgulayan "a few" gerekir; "few" (a'sız) neredeyse kimsenin yardım etmediğini anlatır ve cümleyle çelişir.

Practice

Name: _____

Date: _____

Score: _____ / 19

PART A · QUICK CHECK

1. I have _____ questions for you.

a) much

b) little

c) a little

d) a few

2. Find the mistake and correct it.

We have ^A a few money ^B left for the trip. ^C

Correction: _____

3. Don't worry, we have _____ time before the meeting.

a) little

b) a few

c) a little

d) few

PART B · PRACTICE

4. _____ people came to the meeting. It was almost empty.

a) Few

b) A few

c) Little

d) A little

5. There is _____ hope of finding survivors now.

a) a few

b) little

c) few

d) a little

6. Could I have _____ sugar in my tea, please? (a little / a few)

7. Find the mistake and correct it.

Few of ^A my friends helped me, so ^B I finished the project easily. ^C

Correction: _____

8. A friend asks if you know anyone in the new city. You know two or three people.

What do you say?

a) Yes, I know little people there.

b) Yes, I know few people there.

c) Yes, I know a few people there.

d) Yes, I know a little people there.

9. "She has few friends." What does it suggest?

a) She has no friends at all.

b) She is probably lonely.

c) She has enough friends.

d) She has many friends.

10. I speak _____ French — enough to order food.

a) little

b) a few

c) a little

d) few

PART C · FINAL CHECK

11. There were _____ mistakes in your essay. Well done!

- a) little b) much c) few d) a little

12. We need _____ eggs for the cake — maybe three.

- a) a few b) little c) a little d) few

13. Hurry up! We have very _____ time. (little / few)

14. Find the mistake and correct it.

I have ^A little ^B brothers and sisters — just one brother. ^C

Correction: _____

15. He had _____ money, so he couldn't buy the book.

- a) little b) a few c) few d) a little

16. Your teacher asks if you have any questions. You have two.

What do you say?

- a) Yes, I have little questions.
b) Yes, I have a little questions.
c) Yes, I have a few questions.
d) Yes, I have few questions.

17. "There's a little milk left." Can you make tea with milk?

- a) No, the milk is bad.
b) Yes, there's some — enough for a cup.
c) We can't know.
d) No, there's no milk.

18. Very _____ students know the answer. It's a hard question.

- a) a few b) few c) a little d) little

19. Which sentence is correct?

- a) I'll be ready in few minute.
b) I'll be ready in little minutes.
c) I'll be ready in a little minutes.
d) I'll be ready in a few minutes.

Answer Key

Kısa açıklamalar, her cevabın hangi kurala dayandığını gösterir.

PART A · QUICK CHECK

1. **d) a few** — Sayılabilir çoğul, olumlu → a few.
2. **B — a few money → a little money** — money sayılamaz → a little.
3. **c) a little** — Olumlu, yeterli → a little.

PART B · PRACTICE

4. **a) Few** — Neredeyse hiç (olumsuz), sayılabilir → few.
5. **b) little** — Olumsuz, sayılamaz → little.
6. **a little** — Sayılamaz, olumlu → a little.
7. **A — Few of → A few of** — Olumlu sonuç → a few.
8. **c) Yes, I know a few people there.** — Olumlu, sayılabilir → a few.
9. **b) She is probably lonely.** — few → olumsuz ton: çok az.
10. **c) a little** — Olumlu, sayılamaz → a little.

PART C · FINAL CHECK

11. **c) few** — Neredeyse hiç hata → few (olumlu durum ama "çok az" anlamı).
12. **a) a few** — Birkaç (yeterli) → a few.
13. **little** — Olumsuz, sayılamaz → little.
14. **B — little → few** — brothers sayılabilir → few.
15. **a) little** — Olumsuz sonuç, sayılamaz → little.
16. **c) Yes, I have a few questions.** — Olumlu, sayılabilir → a few.
17. **b) Yes, there's some — enough for a cup.** — a little → az ama var.
18. **b) few** — Olumsuz, sayılabilir → few.
19. **d) I'll be ready in a few minutes.** — minutes sayılabilir → a few.

Bu dersin interaktif versiyonu (anında geri bildirimli alıştırımlar):

<https://abonlinenglish.school/grammar/b1/few-vs-a-few-little-vs-a-little>